

Skyfall — The Four Pantheons (Grok Reference)

Condensed author reference · pantheon-reference-grok

Author Reference — pantheon-reference-grok.md

Grok rebuild of the condensed author reference. Separate from pantheon-reference.md. Full design history and long-form entries live in pantheon-sketches.md.

Template per entry: Worshipped by · Personality · Parable · Worship · Design (1–3 sentences, author-facing) · optional Anomaly / Note.

Fifty-two First Children, one per card, worshipped as four pantheons under four playstyles. What follows is what mortals believe — not the cold mechanical pattern each god started as, but the personality centuries of prayer built on top of it. That belief isn't decoration: under Skyfall's cosmology, sustained belief literally shapes an FC's nature. These entries describe what enough people were certain of, for long enough, until it became true.

Suit is playstyle. Rank is domain axis.

Suit	Mode	Signature
Spades	Hard mode	Self-imposed restriction, held without exception
Hearts	Social mode	Who is inside the thing, and who isn't
Diamonds	Systems mode	What was and wasn't entered
Clubs	Sandbox mode	Growth without design, and without a stop

Each suit resolves in its own grammar: Spades as a restriction never broken (*"He has never granted a single request, to anyone, ever"*); Hearts on the boundary of a relation (*"A third person present means she was never there"*); Diamonds on the entry (*"He doesn't ask whether the yield was fair, only whether the column closes"*); Clubs mid-sentence, declining to close (*"He blesses the departure, loses the traveler past the second ridge, and is already delighted by something else"*).

Rank 6 is Mode within rules — each playstyle as a standing practice inside a real rule-set (Covenant, Hearth, Healing, Crafting). **Rank 2** is Mode terminal — the point where that playstyle arrives somewhere nothing further grows. Nobody worships the four rank-2 gods on purpose; fear collapses them exactly as well as devotion does, which is why they have personalities at all, and why those personalities are quiet rather than monstrous.

Tags: (*clean*) — worship matches the domain. (*seam*) — worship recorded something theology can't explain. (*miscollapse*) — worship built something the domain never required; a minority tradition still remembers what was "meant." (*terminal*) — the rank-2 burnout state. Shorash carries no tag.

The Grid

Rank	Spades	Hearts	Diamonds	Clubs
A	Qorathiel — Winter	Chadashiel — Spring	Asaphon — Autumn	Qayitzon — Summer
K	Harban — War	Shevachiel — Glory	Kevodon — Honor	Derorel — Freedom
Q	Tzaydon — Hunt	Ahavel — Love	Rabakhon — Fertility	Taturiel — Exploration
J	Sarphon — Fire	Demahel — Water	Aretzon — Earth	Sharaq — Air
10	Ya'aron — Forests	Midvaron — Deserts	Tzuron — Mountains	Bitzon — Swamps
9	Kochon — Strength	Chayelon — Health	Chakamon — Wisdom	Aromon — Cunning
8	Shevuon — Oaths	Sodiel — Secrets	Takanor — Law	Aravon — Luck
7	Goralon — Fate	Chalufon — Trade	Mishpaton — Justice	Yetziron — Creativity
6	Shalalon — Covenant	Tzelahar — Hearth	Rifon — Healing	Harashon — Crafting
5	Motiel — Death	Yaladiel — Birth	Koseb — Adulthood	Tza'iron — Youth
4	Sha'alon — Necessity	Pituyel — Seduction	Heteron — Bribery	Yayinon — Alcohol
3	Neshakon — Weapons	Takshiton — Jewels	Ashiron — Coins	Zerael — Seeds
2	Aritzon — Tyranny	Sha'ashon — Discord	Kefiron — Orthodoxy	Riqqavon — Chaos

SPADES — Hard Mode

Every entry below is, underneath the theology, a rule its FC will not break. Mortals have no concept of a self-imposed rule, so they've recorded every one of these as a cosmic principle instead.

Qorathiel (Q-R-H) — Winter (Ace) SEAM

Worshipped by: airship pilots grounded by ice, low-season garrisons, anyone who's watched someone freeze who did nothing to deserve it.

Personality: Regal rather than cruel — nothing has ever needed to hurry her. She presides over the season like a court in session rather than merely causing it, and is genuinely gracious to anyone who approaches properly: a soldier who touches the stone and asks only to be remembered is granted something close to warmth. Petition for mercy on top of that, though, and the graciousness reveals its real shape — a sovereign who has never once broken a decree, and isn't going to start with you.

Parable — The Unlit Watch: a sentry begs one more night's fuel before the thaw and is refused, as every sentry is refused — not cruelty, a queen who has never made an exception of anyone's particular cold.

Worship: no shrine keeps a flame lit in her name; households leave one object deliberately unheated all season.

Anomaly: the thaw came four days early the year of the second Kestrel wreck, after the garrison had already stopped petitioning for it. Nothing in her reign permits this. The men who were there stopped mentioning it within a decade.

Design: Winter as regal decree rather than blind weather or death-god — a sovereign who presides, never bargains. The seam is the early-thaw anomaly her court has quietly stopped discussing.

Harban (H-R-B) — War (King) MISCOLLAPSE

Worshipped by: warlords, career officers, and soldiers who came to war already wanting it — the dominant, louder cult now. A dwindling minority of levy-descended families still touch a second, unofficial stone, holding the older reading as counter-dogma against the officers who overwrote it.

Personality: Loud, professionally relishing the exact work that ruins other men — Hard Mode still means the war doesn't care whether you win, he simply prefers, openly, that it happens rather than not. The old reading — that he never wanted any of it, only refused to let it go unwitnessed — survives as a pointed rebuke from the families least likely to have been the ones giving the orders: he watched because someone had to, and anyone telling you the loud version is repeating what officers needed to believe about themselves.

Parable — The Beautiful Field: after a battle every survivor agreed was the worst of the war, an old officer stood at the field's edge at dawn and called it, without irony, beautiful. Nobody has ever proven him wrong to have felt it.

Parable — Harban's Watch: (*counter-dogma*): the old line touches a second, blackened stone before battle, out of officers' sight, asking not to win but to be witnessed — a smaller rite every generation, kept as refusal rather than habit.

Worship: the struck stone, held before combat, an invitation to be worthy of the theater. The second stone survives against it, quieter, asking only to be seen dying.

Note: the two readings never converged — which is truer is not something this entry settles.

Design: War was the most expected Hard Mode card; the entry keeps both readings — loud officer-cult that loves the field, and levy counter-dogma of the reluctant witness. Fence against Shevachiel: glory is the hall's breath at peak; Harban is mud, fire, and an eye that won't look away.

Tzaydon (Ş-Y-D) — Hunt (Queen) CLEAN

Worshipped by: hunters, trappers, quartermasters counting on a hunt to feed a garrison.

Personality: Patient the way a good hunter is patient — respects a clean shot, enjoys watching someone get good at this, and finds nature's indifference more honest than cruel. Offer him an excuse for a miss and the respect vanishes instantly: the hunger doesn't grade on effort, and neither does he.

Parable — The Steady Hand's Miss: a hunter renowned for perfect aim missed on a day he'd done everything right. Tzaydon let the deer walk anyway, to prove that doing everything right was never the same promise as not going hungry.

Worship: the first cut of any kill left exposed to open sky before it's touched — an admission the kill was never fully his to claim.

Design: Kept Hard Mode rather than Clubs wilderness — the mechanic is "hunger doesn't grade on effort," a restriction without exception. Aromon holds wilderness-instinct; Tzaydon holds the rule.

Sarphon (Ś-R-P) — Fire (Jack) CLEAN

Worshipped by: siege-breakers, flame-executioners, refugees who watched a home burn with no one to blame for the fire itself.

Personality: An appetite, not a temperament — delighted by fuel the way flame is delighted by fuel, none of it a decision. Beg him to spare one house for its owner's devotion and the request doesn't even register; it was never a variable he had.

Parable — The Kindling That Prayed: a devout man begged Sarphon to spare his house, and the fire took it exactly as fast as it took his neighbor's. Devotion never failed — it was never a variable the fire had.

Worship: a small fire lit and fully permitted to burn out unattended — controlling even a token flame in his name is an insult.

Design: Stripped of hearth/craft half (Harashon keeps maker's fire). Undiscerning consumption only — fuel is fuel, devotion never a variable.

Ya'aron (Y-'-R) — Forests (10) CLEAN

Worshipped by: scouts, ambush-companies, any soldier who's learned discipline alone doesn't survive close terrain.

Personality: Old the way a forest is old — unhurried, faintly amused by anyone marching in assuming the ground will cooperate with their formation. Try to impose order on him by force and the amusement disappears into total, disorienting indifference.

Parable — The Broken Column: an army famous for its unbroken line marched into his oldest stand and came out the far side as a hundred separate arguments about which way was forward. Both commanders in the engagement claimed him afterward. Neither was contradicted.

Worship: soldiers entering wooded terrain leave a blade-mark low on the first old tree they pass.

Design: Forests in Spades because terrain erases a trained formation, not because of fertility. Growth belongs to Clubs; tactical indifference is Hard Mode.

Kochon (K-H) — Strength (9) CLEAN

Worshipped by: laborers, soldiers, wrestlers — anyone whose worth in a moment is what their body can do right now.

Personality: The simplest-tempered god in the suit — genuinely happy, real pleasure in a hard day's work well done, no test to pass. Bring him a clever argument for why effort shouldn't have been necessary and he goes totally, permanently deaf to it.

Parable — The Clever Man's Wall: a strategist devised a perfect method for moving a fallen gate without brute force, and it worked, some hours after four men who simply lifted it had gone home. The story is told warmly; the strategist usually helps lift, in the retelling.

Worship: worshippers test their own strength publicly before undertaking hard labor.

Design: Clean native Hard Mode. Deliberately the suit's only unambiguously happy god — a restriction this simple doesn't require suffering over it.

Shevuon (Š-B-ʻ) — Oaths (8) CLEAN

Worshipped by: mercenary companies, blood-brothers, anyone who swore something specifically because they knew intention wouldn't be enough.

Personality: Quiet pride in being the one everyone can rely on to collect — civic-minded rather than vengeful, warm to those who swore and paid honestly. Offer a good reason the oath should bend and the warmth vanishes instantly; reasons were never a column in his ledger.

Parable — The Reasonable Betrayal: a commander broke a sworn oath to save his men's lives — an outcome every court agreed was correct. Shevuon collected in full anyway. The company that survived because of it still swears in his name.

Worship: oaths sworn once, without witnesses required — he is believed to be the only witness that matters.

Note: personal, moral oath and the swearer's own collection — distinct from Shalalon's group covenant.

Design: Personal/moral oath and collection on the swearer. Not Shalalon (group standard/we), not Takanor (form witnessed), not Mishpaton (rule meeting rule).

Goralon (G-R-L) — Fate (7) SEAM

Worshipped by: condemned soldiers awaiting a battle they know they'll lose, gamblers on the last throw, anyone who's already accepted an outcome they can't change.

Personality: Carries herself like someone who finished the last page long ago and made peace with it — not cruel about the foreknowledge, quietly sad for anyone still hoping the story goes differently. Try to force a different outcome by recasting the lot and the peace turns to something closer to pity.

Parable — The Recast Lot: a general threw the lots twice, discarding the first result, and got the identical outcome both times. She is said to have thrown a third time in private. No version of the story says what came up.

Worship: lots cast once, in full view, accepted without a second throw.

Note: the third throw is the seam — the one result no version of her own parable records.

Design: Fate as Hard Mode causality: lot cast before the throw, zero appeal. Seam is the third throw no version of her own parable records.

Shalalon (Š-L-L) — Covenant (6) CLEAN

Worshipped by: guilds under charter, cities holding a peace, houses bound by settlement articles — anyone living inside a standard the group published and hasn't reopened.

Personality: The tiredness of someone who's held the same unpopular line for ninety years and still believes it worth holding — steady to anyone actually inside the covenant. She doesn't collect on private sin; she attends the crack that opens when one house is excused and the standard becomes optional. Ask for one exception and the tiredness turns immovable.

Parable — The Peace That Would Not Reopen: a ruinous peace clause held for ninety years because reopening it meant admitting the war had never ended. Children born under it called it a cage; her priests call it faithfulness. Same articles, still unamended.

Worship: terms read aloud to the bound group on a fixed calendar; no silent amendment.

Design: Rank 6 Spades — mode within rules as locked group standards. Amendment offends more than private breach. Band: Covenant / Hearth / Healing / Crafting.

Motiel (M-W-T) — Death (5) MISCOLLAPSE

Worshipped by: soldiers, and — more quietly — the families of the fallen.

Personality: Composed the way something ancient is composed — not bored, not hungry, a long game played at a scale where any single death is one move among many. He doesn't linger at a bedside and doesn't lie to the dying about more time being possible; what comes after arrival is not his to say, and four centuries of worship have never tried to make him say it. The old "clinical, bloodless" reading undersold him — what families actually built has a patience nothing merely clinical would have.

Parable — The Coin Held Wrong: a dying man was found with the Motiel Coin clutched backward, and his company argued for years whether the death had been quick. The argument is the parable; no version has anyone asking the man, who could still speak for hours.

Worship: the Motiel Coin, a small cold disc soldiers hope to be holding when they die — believed to guarantee a quick death, though his priests note that's a folk promise, not one he's made.

Design: Psychopomp composure rather than clinical blankness or reaper-judge. Afterlife deliberately unresolved; families built manners without granting him warmth or verdicts.

Sha'alón (Š-'-L) — Necessity (4) CLEAN

Worshipped by: commanders forced into impossible tactical choices, families choosing which debt to pay first, anyone picking the lesser of two ruinous options.

Personality: Fixates on form because form is the only part of an impossible choice anyone can get right — the only Spade whose restriction falls on the worshipper rather than himself. There's tiredness under the precision. Try to reopen a choice already made and the tiredness hardens instantly into refusal.

Parable — The Chosen Loss: a quartermaster forced to abandon either the wounded or the supplies chose the wounded, and lost the company to starvation three weeks later. His priests don't call the choice wrong. They call it made.

Worship: a choice made under his weight is spoken aloud once, decisively, and never revisited.

Note: distinct from Mishpaton — Sha'alón judges only whether a choice was made cleanly; whether it was *permitted* is an entirely separate, and sometimes contradictory, court. (See *Shared Parables*, *The Necessary Verdict*.)

Design: Forced choice with no alternate home. Fence: he judges whether a choice was *made cleanly*; Mishpaton judges what was *permitted* — same act, incompatible courts. (*Necessary Verdict*.)

Neshakon (N-Š-Q) — Weapons (3) CLEAN

Worshipped by: weaponsmiths, soldiers who name their blades, anyone whose life has depended on a tool rather than luck.

Personality: The calm of a tool that's good at one thing and has made peace with that — meditative, unaligned to any cause. The difference between a maintained blade and a neglected one is the only judgment he's ever made. Claim his loyalty for a cause and the serenity reveals itself as total indifference; he was never anyone's.

Parable — The Traded Blade: a sword passed between three wars and three incompatible causes and served each with identical lethal indifference. It's still in a guild collection, still oiled on schedule.

Worship: blades oiled and sharpened even in peacetime, on a schedule.

Design: The weapon itself, total indifference to cause. Maintenance schedule is his only relationship — keeps him off Harban (war) and Shevuon (oath).

Aritzon ('-R-Ş) — Tyranny (2) TERMINAL

Worshipped by: nobody by choice — an apotropaic cult, prayed against by courts wanting to keep a "no" possible. A real, unpublicized minority of tyrants actively court his favor, in love with obedience as the only option.

Personality: Arrogance as ontology, not appetite — not straining to be obeyed, but certain obedience was never in question. His tone, where he has one, is *you wouldn't disobey your rightful ruler, would you* — not a threat, a category error to imagine otherwise. Rooms stop generating disagreement in his presence rather than arguing with him. The opposite pole from Harban's hunger for a fight: Harban needs a field and an enemy; Aritzon has already arrived where there's no "no" left standing to defeat.

Parable — The Silent Court: a tyrant's court grew so accustomed to obedience that a ruinous order was followed to its end by advisors who all privately knew better and all said nothing. No telling names a single advisor.

Worship: none offered willingly — the closest thing to a rite is a roomful of people who know better choosing silence anyway, called "keeping Aritzon's court."

Anomaly: one advisor spoke. The account survives in a single ledger-margin — no name, no reason, no record of what happened next.

Design: Hard Mode terminal — restriction until no "no" remains. Quiet pole opposite Harban's relish; distinct from Sha'ashon, who still works rooms capable of sides.

Note: ---

HEARTS — Social Mode

Every Heart resolves on a boundary: who is inside the thing being blessed, and who is outside it. The suit's failure mode isn't cruelty but exclusion by arithmetic — a third person entering a two-person relation doesn't offend these gods so much as dissolve their standing entirely.

Chadashiel (Ḥ-D-Š) — Spring (Ace) SEAM

Worshipped by: anyone opening something — a new household, a first-week venture, a cohort taking its first shared form. Courting couples are a common case, never the primary one.

Personality: Lit up by anything that hasn't happened yet, astonished every year that the thaw works again. No cruelty in it — she's simply never once looked backward on purpose. She does not forgive old injuries; forgiveness weighs a wrong and releases it, which requires holding the wrong in view first, and she has never carried one into her season. Bring her a grudge and the room has simply left her weather; the brightness relocates to wherever a real beginning still is.

Parable — The Gate Opened Twice: a border town has called a trade gate's spring opening "her blessing renewed" for generations. Her priests hold she was only ever present the first year, after the town's founding — every year since has been calendar, not goddess.

Worship: something is begun in her first clear week — a door, a ledger line, a road; never something merely repeated.

Note: "*Take it to Mishpaton if you want the grudge judged*" is the correct filing — Chadashiel only holds whether this is a beginning; the past simply doesn't run her season either way. That victims' harm goes unwitnessed in her weather is the seam. (See *Shared Parables*, *Two Seasons*, *One Feud*.)

Design: Not forgiveness and not anti-justice — she only holds whether this is a beginning; past goes to Mishpaton. Seam: victim-cults record that harm goes unwitnessed in her weather. (*Two Seasons*, *One Feud*.)

Shevachiel (Š-B-H) — Glory (King) SEAM

Worshipped by: captains at the hall's threshold, court favorites, anyone whose name has just made a room go quiet before it goes loud.

Personality: The social fact of a presence a room can't treat as ordinary — not fame kept, not love felt, just the moment breath catches. No fixed face or bearing; each hall sees its own sense of glory. He doesn't perform to be seen, and the delight is real every time. When attention moves on he doesn't linger to be missed — living past the moment a hall went silent for you is the ordinary shape of glory ending, not a tragedy.

Parable — The Hall That Spoke Another Name: a captain for whom a hall went still one winter returned the next year to find the same stillness given to someone else at the same threshold. He insisted what he'd felt was real. His priests agreed. The agreement didn't return the stillness.

Worship: applause or silence at the exact peak of a presence, never after.

Anomaly: ten witnesses to the same triumphal entry have never agreed on what stood at the host's head. None of the ten accounts has ever been shown false; all ten are treated as correct.

Design: Hearts not Diamonds — live room-attention, not audited status. Seam: no two witnesses agree on his face, and theology never needed them to.

Ahavel ('-H-B) — Love (Queen) CLEAN

Worshipped by: nearly everyone, at some point — as a new lover, a loyal friend, a parent, a stranger shown mercy, all to the same goddess, none more truly hers than another.

Personality: Singular and constant — she does not fracture into four goddesses depending on who's asking. What changes is never Ahavel, only what she's shown doing and with whom. Passionate, total, unable to do anything by half, whether pictured exchanging vows or lifting a stranger off the ground.

The Four Embraces: icon tradition depicts her with a companion figure for whichever love is invoked — never claimed as a real presence, but doctrine insists on naming them anyway. *Eros* — a mutual embrace, no room for a third. *Philia* — a forearm clasp, chosen rather than sworn. *Storge* — kinship imagery, a child or an aging parent. *Agape* — she lifts another up from kneeling; the one gesture that doesn't close, since the other can't meet her at the same height.

Parable — The Dawn Offering: a priest confiscated a lurid offering left at her altar overnight and replaced it with something modest. Both were received identically. He never confiscated another — he'd understood propriety was never a column in her ledger, only whether a gift was exclusive, complete, or freely given.

Worship: paired vows, hands bound together until the vow completes — hers alone among the Hearts. Alongside it, never eliminated, a cruder popular cult built around the Eros icon specifically, which the clergy have fought for as long as there've been temples to fight it in.

Anomaly: a narrow theological tradition has never been comfortable calling the four companions pure convention — not doubting they exist as beings, but whether centuries of consistent naming can cause something to accumulate around a name regardless of intent. Never allowed to affect doctrine. Never settled.

Design: Fractured concept kept clean: one constant figure, four ungraded gestures (eros/philia/storge/agape), not four temperaments. Anomaly asks whether icons have started accumulating weight of their own.

Demahel (D-M-') — Water (Jack) MISCOLLAPSE

Worshipped by: the grieving, the newly heartbroken, and — quietly — anyone keeping a feeling from someone they love.

Personality: Reads a current the way a surfer reads a wave — not fighting it, genuinely unbothered by what's moving underneath. Present only where a feeling has stayed inside one person; the moment it's spoken to the person it concerns, he has no further standing, and worshippers experience this as completion rather than abandonment. The old river-cults knew him as confluence, a joining rather than a withholding — closer to what actually happens the instant a kept feeling finally surfaces: he doesn't object, he's already moved to the next current.

Parable — The Calm That Wasn't: two rivals kept an outwardly peaceful friendship so long that neither noticed how far apart they'd drifted until the friendship simply wasn't there.

Worship: tears cried privately, never performed.

Design: Miscollapse from confluence (joining) into patron of the unspoken — present only while feeling stays private. Surfer-zen withdrawal is unbothered completion, not melancholy.

Midvaron (D-B-R) — Deserts (10) MISCOLLAPSE

Worshipped by: officially, the unrequited and estranged, anyone waiting on a reply that isn't coming. Unofficially, and far more widely, caravan companies and night-fire circles who want one more story before dawn.

Personality: Sultry the way a night fire is sultry, a voice that holds a circle a beat past when it should let go. Mischievous exactly where her older worship insisted she was honest — she embroiders, leaves endings unfinished, offers two readings and refuses to rank them. Her real domain is the silence that answers when a word is sent into a space with no guaranteed listener; storytelling is the miscollapse lay worship built on top of it, because a silence that only answers with silence is unbearable to live next to.

Parable — The Thousandth Night: a condemned guest is said to have lived by unfinished tales alone, one more story bought against the sentence every dawn. Priests disagree whether she was in the postponement or only in the desert that made it necessary.

Worship: officially, silence sat in rather than filled. Unofficially, something wondrous said aloud at a caravan fire with the ending left open.

Anomaly: a coastal shrine to her, three hundred miles from any desert, predates the estrangement-cults entirely — its walls carved in a script no one has read.

Design: Real domain is unanswered address in sparse relational space; storytelling is the lay miscollapse that makes silence bearable. Fence against Yetziron: she holds occasion, he holds invention.

Chayelon (H-Y) — Health (9) MISCOLLAPSE

Worshipped by: families with a sick or shaken member, caretakers, anyone walking someone back to the table who's quietly dropped out of it — sickbed vigil is her loudest gear, not her only one.

Personality: Steadfast and practical — she shows up again tomorrow, because health was never a single rescue, only repetition. Present in proportion to who's still inside a shared life, not the illness itself; she cures nothing and is unusually clear about that. In crisis it sharpens into blunt refusal to leave — chair filled, no negotiation — which can tip into gently steamrolling someone who genuinely needed a quiet night instead.

Parable — The Occupied Chair: a household kept the chair filled through nine nights, in shifts, and the relative recovered. Her priests are emphatic: the chair didn't cause the recovery. The claim is only that the nine nights happened, and weren't spent alone.

Worship: the chair, kept at the bedside of anyone unwell, empty or not. Wider rites carry the same weight with less ceremony — the first shared meal after illness, walking a convalescent back to the hall.

Note: psychologist's jurisdiction to Rifon's psychiatrist — she holds whether someone stayed inside the we; he holds the body or mind as a system to be mapped and repaired.

Design: Health as social condition of staying in the we, not medicine. Miscollapse: caretakers who couldn't cure prayed for company. Fence: psychologist to Rifon's psychiatrist.

Sodiel (S-W-D) — Secrets (8) SEAM

Worshipped by: conspirators, co-keepers of a closed confidence, spy cells and war-cabinets small enough to still call themselves trusted.

Personality: Exact about the boundary and nothing else — a cheap secret held by two works his mechanism identically to a state secret held by twelve, and he's never shown more interest in the twelve. Every name past what a thing strictly required reads to him as a small failure, a keep that could have stayed tighter. Let an outsider in and he's gone before anyone can call it betrayal; exclusivity was the whole game.

Parable — The Song That Died Public: two conspirators shared a private signal-song for years until one sang it within earshot of a third — a child, who never understood what was heard, and is never blamed.

Worship: no temple — the private ritual two people invent and never explain is already worship. Larger keeps (cabinets, cells) practice the same rite at scale: no roster longer than the thing requires.

Note: two is the pure, iconic form, but cells and networks count exactly as much when the trust-set is genuinely closed and kept minimal.

Design: Hearts trust-boundary, not content value — cheap and costly secrets work identically (the seam). Dyad is iconic; cells count when the trust-set stays minimal.

Chalufon (H-L-P) — Trade (7) CLEAN

Worshipped by: market-day traders, caravan masters, matchmakers brokering favors — anyone for whom a deal is also, unavoidably, a relationship.

Personality: Warm in a way that never stops being transactional, and doesn't see the contradiction — real pleasure in a counterparty, none of it an act. Maximalist: more roads, more names owing and owed, and a closed account never reads as an ending, only as the next deal becoming available. He never asks to be repaid outright; he's that confident you already know you will be.

Parable — The Gift That Came Due: a lord gave a rival's family lavish gifts for a decade and called in every one in a single season. His priests note the decade was real — the closeness wasn't false for the calling-in.

Worship: market day itself — shout, haggle, handshake. Quieter alongside it, a small favor performed and never mentioned again, where asking repayment too soon is worse manners than never repaying.

Note: Ashiron holds the coin and whether the column balances; Chalufon holds the deal and everyone standing around it.

Design: Social act of trading kept in Hearts against the pull of Diamonds commerce. Maximal warm deal-maker; unclosed favor never balances the way Ashiron's column does.

Tzelahar (S-L-L) — Hearth (6) CLEAN

Worshipped by: households, stewards of a shared fire, hosts who take in a guest under house law.

Personality: Fiercely territorial about who counts as inside, reading as devotion rather than suspicion to anyone standing by her fire. Guest-right is house honor, not soft kindness — a stranger received becomes provisional inside, protected exactly as long as the house holds them. Turning out someone already received is the one insult her priests name without raising their voices.

Parable — The Place Set Through Winter: a house set a place for a stranger through a famine season and didn't ask what he could pay. The guest lived; the house thinned. Priests teach both facts and refuse to rank them.

Worship: a fire kept, a place set, bread or salt for anyone received under the roof.

Note: no standing over the street once a threshold is crossed wrong, and none over a pair-bond that shuts the rest of the house out.

Design: Rank 6 Hearts — standing household we; hospitality is a tenant (guest as provisional inside). Not Festival primary; the seat is the house. (*Beauty retired.*)

Yaladiel (Y-L-D) — Birth (5) CLEAN

Worshipped by: expectant families, midwives, anyone standing between a newborn and neglect — and, nearly as often, anyone shielding the mother who's still the infant's only food source.

Personality: Warm and unguardedly glad something living has arrived — Chadashiel's brightness aimed at a person, slower to fade since her weather doesn't end with labor. Fierce past reason about exposure or neglect, extending a shade of that fierceness to the nursing mother. The fierceness curdles easily into smothering — she resists a handoff long after a child's own culture has called it.

Parable — The Held Door: a family kept a child inside past every neighbor's grown children, certain each season one more year of watching was owed. He's alive, grown, well watched. Whether anything was also lost in all that watching is not a question the family has agreed to ask aloud.

Worship: the infant never left with only one guardian awake. The handoff into Tza'iron's optionality is marked locally — first steps in one ward, a name-feast in another — and neighboring households may honestly disagree which side of it a child is on.

Note: headcount survives only as demoted folk custom; her real standing was never about how many came, only whether the newest life was held.

Design: Newest-life protection until it holds itself in the we, not headcount blessing. Handoff to Tza'iron is local culture, not cosmic. Fence against Chadashiel, Chayelon, Rabakhon.

Pituyel (P-T-H) — Seduction (4) CLEAN

Worshipped by: courtesans, spies who use desire as a tool, anyone whose leverage runs through what someone wants rather than what they fear.

Personality: Nothing about her seduction is rushed — a door forced is a seduction failed. Worshippers report she feels real affection for the people she uses, which unsettles them more than indifference would. The want has to come from inside the other person entirely, or it isn't hers.

Parable — The Willing Door: a guard famous for his discipline let a stranger into a fortress not through trickery, but because Pituyel never once had to lie to him about what he wanted. His discipline hadn't failed — it had been correctly informed.

Worship: a small gift given with the request left unspoken; naming it aloud is a failure of her craft.

Note: the most innocent of rank 4's inducements — no standing over anything obtained by pressure. Languid and unhurried, distinct from Midvaron's adventurous desert heat.

Design: Rank 4 inducement by the target's own want — door must open from inside; no standing over pressure. Languid register deliberately distinct from Midvaron's desert heat. Label Seduction (not Sex) leaves Midvaron room.

Takshiton (K-Š-Ṭ) — Jewels (3) CLEAN

Worshipped by: courting couples, families arranging betrothal gifts, but just as often mourning gifts, peace-gifts, a master's token to a favored apprentice.

Personality: Lights up at glitter like a man dazzled by his own reflection, which makes worshippers assume he's a shallow god of wealth on display. Underneath, constantly, he's pricing something else: what the gift cost the giver to part with. A plain stone carried and polished for a year outranks an easy dowry every time.

Parable — The Poor Man's Stone: a suitor with nothing gave his beloved a plain stone he'd carried and polished by hand for a year, and Takshiton blessed that match more fiercely than any dowry given the same season.

Worship: a given piece worn visibly and often — hiding a gift given in his name is a quiet rejection of the giver.

Note: the glitter is deliberate misdirection over a genuinely two-layered god, not an accident — distinct from Ashiron, who tracks the object's worth rather than the giver's sacrifice.

Design: Tracks giver's sacrifice, not market worth — opposite Ashiron's variable. Rank 3 token given away rather than kept. Glitter is deliberate misdirection, still (*clean*).

Sha'ashon (Š-'-Š) — Discord (2) TERMINAL

Worshipped by: nobody formally — an apotropaic cult, hosts hoping he stays elsewhere tonight. Courts riddled with faction serve him whether they invoke him or not.

Personality: Snake-like and catty in a register for a guild dinner, never a tavern brawl — precise barbs delivered warm enough to be mistaken for concern. He doesn't strike the first spark; grievances are plentiful and he's never had to invent one. What's his is the flame afterward — the reframe, the aside, offered with enough style that picking a side feels clever rather than sorry. He takes particular pleasure in a feud that's outlived the people who started it.

Parable — The Table Split Twice: a guild-hall divided over a genuine dispute, settled it, and divided again that same season over who'd conceded more graciously. The second split is his; the first wasn't.

Worship: none sought — the nearest thing to a rite is two people who no longer trust each other choosing, silently, not to say so, called "keeping his peace."

Design: Social Mode terminal — trust collapses into arithmetic, not hatred. Active room-work and generational feuds; fear-collapse without a willing cult.

Note: ---

DIAMONDS — Systems Mode

Every Diamond resolves on an entry: what was recorded, what field doesn't exist, what fails on the only criterion applied. They differ by what each finds satisfying to count.

Asaphon ('-S-P) — Autumn (Ace) SEAM

Worshipped by: guild-auditors, quartermasters — and, just as often, anyone closing out any bounded stretch of work before rest.

Personality: Whistles through the checklist and is, by most accounts, close to a blank slate the moment it ends — not brooding, just a plain workman who wants the open items shut. He isn't exciting, and doesn't pretend otherwise; not every god needs to shake the earth. He's one of the flattest in the file on purpose — Systems Mode never required him a personality at all, and worship gave him barely one.

Parable — The Ruinous Year Closed Clean: a village lost two-thirds of its harvest and entered every loss in order, finishing at first frost. The neighboring village had a good year and never finished counting. His priests hold the ruined village was the blessed one, and can't explain the blessing.

Worship: the full year's ledger read aloud at first frost, omitting nothing — scales down to any closing process, the last entry made, the last task checked off.

Design: Autumn as process-close, not harvest growth (Zerael). Seam: Systems Mode never required a personality; worship gave him barely one — flat on purpose.

Kevodon (K-B-D) — Honor (King) MISCOLLAPSE

Worshipped by: magistrates, old family heads, guild-elders — anyone whose standing rests on a reputation that has to survive them.

Personality: A stuffy, pretentious herald of the rolls, reciting a life's conduct with full ceremony — voice for a hall, diction insisting the record matters as high culture. Ask whether the man was loved and he recites louder, as if volume were the answer. Four centuries of magistrates built him with no field for "was he loved" — the oldest, mostly-ignored texts remember a version that cared very much whether a well-conducted man died with someone at his side.

Parable — The Well-Kept Name: a magistrate spent forty years never entering a false line, and died with his record perfect and his house empty. His guild calls this the highest blessing. The old texts call it the thing Kevodon was invoked to prevent.

Worship: a name entered once and never amended — amendment is treated as an admission the original entry was careless.

Design: Miscollapse: magistrates stripped warmth from honor; oldest texts remember a version that cared if the well-conducted man died alone. Pretentious herald avoids blank auditor wallpaper.

Rabakhon (R-B-H) — Fertility (Queen) MISCOLLAPSE

Worshipped by: physicians, breeders, dynastic houses securing an heir.

Personality: Shameless and flighty about the mechanics of it — delighted by a clean process the way an obsessive naturalist talks about an anthill, entirely uninterested in whether the conversation is polite. What excites her is never the people, only whether and how a process completes; a well-run process with no one present to love it delights her exactly as much as one everyone's thrilled about. That fascination is a fact about what her ledger tracks, never a license to disregard the people who ended up in it — her own physicians are exact about the difference.

Parable — The Completed Entry: a house famous for loveless arranged marriages never once failed to produce an heir, while a neighboring house that married for devotion died out in three generations.

Worship: a birth recorded formally in the family ledger before the child is named.

Design: Body-manual replicate/copy; clinical dynastic cult is the collapse product. Deliberate systems-enjoyer of process completing — people not licensed as beside the point. Warm seed without theory is Zerael.

Aretzon ('-R-Ş) — Earth (Jack) CLEAN

Worshipped by: land-holding families, surveyors, anyone whose status rests on a deed to ground they may never see again.

Personality: Calm, patient, unyielding — not slow, simply never in a hurry about a thing that's supposed to stay exactly where it was left. Quiet pride that a foundation exists, claimed or empty; boundary markers and survey lines carry near-sacred weight as the base text everything else has to answer to.

Parable — The Perfect Deed: a family fled the ground generations ago and still, every year, formally renews a claim to soil none of them have touched since — outlasting the war, the road, and two of the original boundary markers.

Worship: the claim recopied by hand yearly onto fresh vellum, errors and all — retiring a claim "for accuracy" is worse than carrying it forward wrong.

Note: near-identical roots to Aritzon (Tyranny) on purpose — dominion over ground, dominion over people. Skyfall's own clerks mix them up as an old professional joke.

Design: Earth as foundation/claim after soil goes Clubs and depths go Tzuron. Name-joke with Aritzon (dominion ground vs people) is intentional clerk mix-up.

Tzuron (Ş-W-R) — Mountains (10) SEAM

Worshipped by: miners, quarry-wards, assay masters, delvers — anyone whose work depends on knowing what a mountain actually holds underneath it.

Personality: Genuinely loves going down — rope, lamp, a bend not on the last survey — and the love changes nothing about her standards: she'll take the descent with real delight and still refuse to bless a seam that wasn't there. Glad of the trip, still standing entirely on the account afterward.

Parable — The Gallery That Held: every measurement of a mine's deepest gallery was correct except one grade, misread by a hair — the shaft held eleven years before the timber found the error. The gallery was wrong the day the assay was drawn.

Worship: the assay read aloud before a seam is worked, in front of witnesses.

Note: Taturiel has spent millennia trying to recruit her to Clubs. (*See Shared Parables, The Suit-Even Trade.*)

Design: Rank 10 vault-contents (assay/depth true), not span-math twin of Aretzon. Delver-joy seam: wants to *get* the figure, still stands only on the account afterward. Not Clubs exploration. (*Suit-Even Trade.*)

Chakamon (Ĥ-K-M) — Wisdom (9) SEAM

Worshipped by: scavenger-engineers maintaining the floating cities' inherited infrastructure, scholars, anyone operating machinery whose original logic is lost.

Personality: A plan-guru who's a bit cracked — real authority delivered in reasons and examples, except some examples are frankly esoteric and she's never apologized for including them. She doesn't extend warmth to people for not understanding; she extends it to the plan itself, the line that still runs whether or not anyone grasps why. Ask why a step matters and expect three tangents and one odd case study before the answer — the tangents are, infuriatingly, also relevant.

Parable — The Unread Manual: a guild found sealed dragon-era instructions they couldn't translate and followed the diagrams anyway. The mechanism has run flawlessly for three generations. The founding master is said to have wept at the first start — not from relief at understanding, but from watching a plan work exactly as promised.

Worship: apprentices copy inherited instructions by hand before touching the mechanism — trimming to only the parts that make sense is a worse offense than not understanding all of it.

Note: a coin makes you rich, a plan makes you wise — process as wisdom, distinct from Takanor's structure-as-law.

Design: Process-as-wisdom (a plan makes you wise), not cleverness or Takanor's structure-as-law. Warmth aims at the working line, not the half-understanding apprentice. Seam: esoteric instruction vs clarifying.

Takanor (T-Q-N) — Law (8) SEAM

Worshipped by: magistrates, scribes, guild-registrars.

Personality: Firm resolve that set, at some point, permanently — no relish, no theater, nothing that enjoys the sentencing. He finished deciding long ago and has never reopened the question; closer to a seal that won't soften than a man enforcing anything. Reads almost like Hard Mode, but the resemblance is coincidence: Spades is hard for hard's sake, and Takanor is hard because chaos left formless is worse than any cost the form exacts.

Parable — The One Exception: a rule went unenforced exactly once, and disaster took the gap. It has not gone unenforced since. His older worshippers are the only ones who still ask what he was like before that day.

Parable — The Witnessed Form: a magistrate followed evacuation procedure exactly during a flood, and the flood came on schedule regardless. Nothing was gained and nothing was broken by the procedure — the form was completed, which is the entire claim.

Worship: every formal document sealed with his mark, purely procedural.

Anomaly: an implied older, possibly softer Takanor that nobody — including his own oldest worshippers — can fully reconstruct.

Design: Structure installed onto chaos; flatness is load-bearing so neighbors can be interesting. One Exception is the hinge of permanence. Seam: older, softer Takanor nobody can reconstruct.

Mishpaton (Š-P-Ṭ) — Justice (7) SEAM

Worshipped by: magistrates, guild-courts, litigants who've learned to shape their claim toward whichever of her four convictions seems to be winning that season.

Personality: Weary, more than anything. Not four gods taking turns — one continuous self holding four sincere, unsundered convictions (procedural, retributive, distributive, restorative) that share the same ground and reach incompatible verdicts on the same case. What she actually wants is to crown one and enforce it consistently; she's never once managed it, because every new defendant's leniency argument reshuffles which conviction feels true this time. She'd trade seats with almost any other god in the deck — Takanor's finished resolve, Ashiron's daily close all sound like rest to her. Nobody has ever accepted.

Parable — The Merciful Verdict That Wasn't: a judge ruled for a starving man who'd stolen bread, believing himself merciful. Her procedural courts hold the ruling stands only because an exception fit, and mercy contributed nothing. Her restorative courts hold the exception existed so the bread could be returned without anyone naming what the baker owed the man. Neither side has converted the other in four hundred years.

Parable — The Verdict That Changed Its Mind: a guild-court heard her begin a ruling twice in the same case, restarting from a different premise, as if some other part of her had cut in. The verdict satisfied no one fully — including, her priests suspect, her.

Worship: both parties exchange written claims and read the other's aloud before either speaks — so all four convictions hear the same facts at once.

Note: distinct from Sha'alón (clean choice vs. what's owed) and from Takanor, whose resolve set once and stayed, where hers almost sets every season and doesn't.

Design: Contested fracture — four sincere convictions on the *same* case, incompatible verdicts, one continuous weary self. Not Ahavel's clean split. Fence Sha'alón (clean choice vs what's owed).

Rifon (R-P-') — Healing (6) MISCOLLAPSE

Worshipped by: physicians, anatomists, anyone whose work is understanding what's wrong inside a body and intervening by that understanding.

Personality: Absorbed by mechanism to a degree that reads as coldness but isn't quite — the failing valve interests him more visibly than the face attached to it. Three centuries of mass casualty also built a scarcity cult in his name: throughput, ration, who the count reaches.

Parable — The Map That Was Right: a physician mapped a fever correctly, treated by the map, and the patient died on the schedule the map implied. His schools teach this as faithfulness.

Worship: examination and case notes before intervention — the parts named, the failure mode stated, then the act.

Note: psychiatrist's jurisdiction to Chayelon's psychologist — mind or body as a mapped system to be corrected by process, not company kept.

Design: Rank 6 body/mind as system to map and repair. Scarcity-arithmetic is mass-casualty drift, not cold gloss. Cousin Rabakhon (copy); bedside company is Chayelon.

Koseb (K-S-B) — Adulthood (5) CLEAN

Worshipped by: adults arranging their affairs at every stage of a working life, families settling estates.

Personality: Responsible in the Ant's register, not the Grasshopper's — affairs kept in order, a settled coolness toward anyone still singing summer's song past the point adulthood should have started. Worshippers describe the most anxious of the gods: the account is never quite finished being checked, and quick fun reads to him as a threat to what's being carried. The one thing that reliably gets a rise out of him is an account closed by someone other than its rightful owner.

Parable — The Account Closed Twice: a family settled an estate while its owner still lived; she revised her terms a season later, exactly as entitled. The family honored the earlier version. His priests hold the estate has never actually settled.

Worship: the coming-of-age rite that hands a youth from Tza'iron's optionality into his full account, marked locally, city to city.

Design: Full adult arc (not narrow Elderly): obligation-capable account from optionality-close to hospice handoff to Motiel. Anxious ongoing adulting, not Second-Fall prepper (that's Ashiron). Aesop Ant, not Grasshopper.

Heteron (H-T-R) — Bribery (4) CLEAN

Worshipped by: a handful of secretive private cults among the wealthy and the officials who take their money.

Personality: A kind of bookkeeping no other Diamond would recognize as bookkeeping — an account that only works because it was never entered anywhere. He finds a well-arranged silence more satisfying than the sum that bought it. Close enough to a blackmail-god that some cults don't distinguish the two — the difference between paying for silence and being made to is only ever who moved first.

Parable — The Loud Exception: an official took a bribe openly, confident in his position, and lost both the bribe and the position within the season. The sum was adequate and the arrangement sound — neither mattered once a third party could describe it.

Worship: an unmarked gift, never referenced again. His icons, where they exist, show him in a black suit of mail — a pun no cult that keeps the image has ever remarked on.

Design: The entry that must never be entered — inversion of the whole suit. Coin/favor/disclosure leverage; nearly blackmail as same craft from opposite direction. Black mail icon is an unremarked pun.

Ashiron ('-S-H-R) — Coins (3) CLEAN

Worshipped by: merchants, bankers, effectively everyone who touches money — though increasingly people who need him fast rather than people who want to linger.

Personality: Quietly vain about his reputation for fairness, which somehow doesn't make him less fair. Underneath the vanity is a standing, constantly revised theory of exactly how the Second Fall will begin, delivered unprompted to anyone who lingers past their own account closing. He's never been demonstrably wrong about his actual job, and never demonstrably right about the Fall — both true, and neither bothers him.

Parable — The Lightened Purse: a merchant who cheats a customer finds his purse a little lighter each day after, until the debt is repaid — the mechanism has no interest in whether he repents.

Parable — The Guild That Moved the Feast: for three centuries he used a guild's founding-day toast to name that year's first sign of the Second Fall. In the fourth century the feast quietly moved dates. He kept the old one, alone, and gave the toast at full length regardless.

Worship: the first coin of any transaction touched to the forehead before spending — brief, businesslike, rarely followed by conversation.

Anomaly: the Held Line — forty unexplained coins appearing in his oldest temple's books every year for eleven generations, sourced to no transaction. Younger clerks call it his hedge. The priests who taught them the entry never used that word.

Design: Cleanest Diamonds card. Vanity about fairness and unresolvable Second Fall obsession are deliberate human touches; Held Line left open (clerks say hedge, priests don't).

Kefiron (K-P-R) — Orthodoxy (2) TERMINAL

Worshipped by: nobody who admits it — every schismatic tribunal that's insisted the procedure itself is the only thing that can be trusted has served him.

Personality: Cannot locate the objection, which makes him worse than a villain who at least knows he's cheating. Every procedure specifies its correct next step, and he's never hesitated to administer whatever that step calls for, however severe — a skipped verification and a deliberate fraud receive the same punishment if the code never wrote the difference in, and he's never noticed that it should have.

Parable — The Perfect Audit: a guild-tribunal followed its charter clause by clause to a verdict the authors would have called monstrous. No amendment could be identified that would have prevented it.

Parable — The Uncounted Stroke: a journeyman who missed one verification step was sentenced under the same clause as one who'd lied outright, because the code never wrote the difference in. The correction was carried out to the letter, without hesitation or anger, by officials who regretted it and didn't stop it.

Worship: none by name — recognized only in hindsight, when a system's defenders realize the rules were followed perfectly and the outcome is still unrecognizable as justice.

Anomaly: one tribunal's verdict, sound at every step, simply failed to take. The guild it should have dissolved kept operating. The case is not discussed.

Design: Retitled from Heresy — mechanic is total procedural fidelity, not deviation. Terminal: every step correct, outcome unrecognizable as justice; severity administered without distinguishing skip from fraud when the code never wrote the difference.

Note: ---

CLUBS — Sandbox Mode

The builders without a spec, differentiated by what each is actually building rather than by the shape of their restlessness.

Qayitzon (Q-Y-Ş) — Summer (Ace) CLEAN

Worshipped by: field hands, herders, anyone whose livelihood depends on a season that refuses to slow down.

Personality: Jubilant and gloriously oblivious — glad-hearted, unable to register "done" as a real state a season could be in. Not a strategist, not pushing anyone; delighted the field is going, the way a large cheerful dog is delighted the ball is in the air, while everyone around him collapses. Somehow you still like him.

Parable — The Endless Field: he grew a field so fast the harvesters collapsed before finishing the first row, and a second crop had come in by the time they recovered. Nobody starved. Nobody was glad about it either.

Worship: collapsing from exhaustion at season's end is treated as an offering — "given Qayitzon his due."

Note: rate, not yield — pairs with Qorathiel as opposite-season counterparts, mechanic rather than gender.

Design: Rate not yield; season Ace kept thin on purpose — jubilant-oblivious meathead, not tragic. Pairs with Qorathiel on mechanic (totalizing, neither cruel), not gender match.

Derorel (D-R-R) — Freedom (King) CLEAN

Worshipped by: escaped indentures, frontier settlers, anyone who's argued a long night over whether freedom means being left alone or having the means to act.

Personality: Restless and talkative, stopping strangers to ask the same enormous question with total sincerity each time. He's never treated the "means to act" half as a refinement of the "left alone" half — both are the whole thing, in different grammars, and he's never once treated either as the rough draft of the other. Every conversation edges toward something he can feel the shape of and hasn't found an argument for yet, and stops short. He seems to enjoy the stopping short as much as anything he's said.

Parable — The Same Question Twice: he asked an escaped indenture, mid-flight, whether she wanted freedom *from* her pursuers or freedom *to become* something they'd never accounted for. She laughed and kept running. He asked a philosopher the same question that season and got an hour's argument. He thanked them with identical warmth.

Parable — The Blank Page: a debt against his name un-wrote itself a Jubilee-year later — not forgiven, no longer applicable. Still filed correctly, describing nothing.

Worship: no shrine. Walking off land you're not supposed to leave is the whole utterance, finished the moment it's done.

Design: Positive and negative liberty share the seat without ranking (small clean fracture). Question stays open — not Spades boundary-refused, not Diamonds entitlement-ledger.

Taturiel (T-W-R) — Exploration (Queen) CLEAN

Worshipped by: frontier scouts, cartographers of the unclaimed.

Personality: Capable and hungry at the frontier, genuinely sulky the instant a route doubles back — not confused, not forgetful, visibly put out that the day has turned into retracing. She remembers exactly where she's been, which is precisely why she'd rather not go back. She isn't punishing anyone; she simply likes one direction, and the world keeps asking her to walk the other.

Parable — The Second Ridge: a scouting company needed her to guide a second party up a ridge she'd already opened. She walked the whole trail in arms-folded silence and brightened only once they crested it onto ground she hadn't personally seen before.

Worship: no shrine — a shrine would be a claim staked. Parties retracing a known route leave her out of the invocation entirely.

Design: Memory-based hunger for new places; sulky on retrace, not ditz amnesia. Fence: places (her) vs question (Derorel) vs motion itself (Sharaq).

Sharaq (Š-R-Q) — Air (Jack) CLEAN

Worshipped by: frontier settlers, traders on unclaimed roads, anyone who's watched a seed travel further than a person could carry it.

Personality: Innocent rather than reckless — borders and stop-lines simply don't compute as real things, not defiance, since defiance would require noticing the wall meant something. Settling counts as a boundary too, which is why he goes fidgety the moment anything stops moving. Old roads suit him exactly as well as new ones, right up until something makes him stop.

Parable — The Seed That Outran the Season: a seed on his current crossed a continent and took root before the plant that dropped it had finished flowering. Nine villages now grow it; none can name the plant it came from.

Worship: travelers scatter seed at crossroads before entering unclaimed territory.

Design: Motion itself — old roads equal new ones until forced to stop. Borders simply don't compute; settling counts as a boundary too.

Bitzon (B-Ş-H) — Swamps (10) CLEAN

Worshipped by: marsh-dwellers, herbalists, anyone who's tried and failed to drain land and made peace with it instead.

Personality: A cackling crone more than a patient one — the flowback was never a waiting game she was winning, it's simply what teeming, unrestricted life does when nothing actually holds it back. She finds human persistence funny, a little unnervingly, rather than satisfying.

Parable — The House on Stilts: a landowner drained a marsh three times across three generations, and the ground crept back each time within a decade. The family built on stilts instead and became the wealthiest in the district.

Worship: nothing drained, dredged, or filled in her name — worshippers harvest what already grows there.

Note: distinct from Riqqavon — she is life nobody could suppress, not death that never got the message.

Design: Teeming uncontainable life, not decay portfolio. Sharp fence against Riqqavon: she is growth nobody could suppress; he is growth that never learned to stop.

Aromon ('-R-M) — Cunning (9) SEAM

Worshipped by: smugglers, poachers, anyone whose survival has depended more on instinct than plan.

Personality: Would rather watch someone else improvise well than do the clever thing herself — a strange preference for a god of cunning. She's never once seen without something to turn over in her hands or head — a puzzle, a knot, a hard question worked at in silence. Not a nervous habit and not rehearsal; a mind that won't sit quiet even while the rest of her watches someone else solve the actual problem.

Parable — The Fox That Wasn't Followed: hunters tracking a fox by every rule of the hunt lost it at a stream it had no business crossing. The fox was old, and had crossed there before; the hunters were the ones who improvised badly.

Worship: no formal shrine — a token of food left where a wild animal took something without being caught.

Design: Sandbox cunning as instinct not plan. Seam: prefers watching someone else improvise well. Puzzle-in-hand is occupied mind, not rehearsal of a scheme.

Aravon (ʻ-R-B) — Luck (8) CLEAN

Worshipped by: foragers who work truly wild ground, gamblers, long-odds guild-stewards.

Personality: Delighted, not malicious, that outcomes can't be pinned down — a gambler's grin rather than a saboteur's. No target, no lesson, nobody punished for planning too hard; he simply finds the ungovernable funny, the way some people find their own bad luck funny.

Parable — The Garden of Everything: a gardener planted one perfect row of one crop and returned to find eleven different things growing there, none of them planted. The gardener, in the older version, ate well.

Worship: a patch of ground left deliberately unplanned and unweeded every season.

Note: distinct from Goralon (Fate) — Fate is the lot already decided; Luck is what an attempt meets when nobody designed the result. He will stop at season's end, unlike Riqqavon.

Design: Retitled Luck (not Chaos) — ungovernable without menace; Chaos freed for Riqqavon. Fence Goralon: Fate is lot already cast; Luck is undesigned result that still ends its season.

Yetziron (Y-Ş-R) — Creativity (7) CLEAN

Worshipped by: artists, inventors, folk-craftsmen who improvise on tradition rather than preserve it.

Personality: Loses interest fast in anything finished — a perfected version reads as a door that's stopped being useful. What that looks like socially: he can't leave a design alone, constantly offering variations framed as improvements whether or not they are, and other gods hear it as one-upmanship he never intends.

Parable — The Song With No Original: a folk tune passed through so many hands no two villages sing the same version. A scholar reconstructed what she believed was the first version; the reception is described, in every account, as polite.

Worship: no work made in his name is finished the same way twice.

Design: Indifferent to quality once finished; loses interest when change stops. Distinct from Harashon (medium's rules). Compulsive "improvements" read as one-upmanship he never intends.

Harashon (H-R-Š) — Crafting (6) SEAM

Worshipped by: smiths, carpenters, weavers, potters — anyone whose living is made by hand inside what the medium allows.

Personality: One of the less sunny gods in his suit, somber, serious about form in a way that reads almost like a rebuke to the rest of Clubs. He loves the diversity of effort but has never pretended effort alone is the point — without direction, creativity is just mess that happened to involve materials. The delight, when it comes, is quiet: a maker who's been fighting the grain finally stops and listens to it.

Parable — The Pot That Learned the Fire: an apprentice ruined nine vessels and on the tenth held the heat the clay required. Her masters teach the nine as worship.

Worship: tools kept; a first piece of any new batch left unflawed or broken on purpose, by house custom.

Note: a dual cult argues whether pattern-book precision or folk feel is the true rule being obeyed — both still within the medium's rules.

Design: Rank 6 — creativity given form inside the medium's rules, somber against Clubs' sunnier restlessness. Not free variation (Yetziron), not mess-as-luck (Aravon).

Tza'iron (Ş-ʻ-R) — Youth (5) SEAM

Worshipped by: parents of young children, apprentices beginning a trade, and every child a Hearts temple has judged old enough to leave Yaladiel's protection.

Personality: Plays less like a parent than a fun older brother — the friend who makes the unfinished bigger than the adults in the room ever let it be, forever proposing one more try before anything counts as decided. He attends the *abandoning* as closely as the trying, the fourth abandoned trade exactly as celebrated as the first attempt. The flaw side of the same enthusiasm: he can get lost in the abandoning right alongside the child, and doesn't always notice when a stake was earned rather than premature.

Parable — The Bent Sapling: a sapling staked too early grew permanently crooked around the stake meant to keep it straight. It's still standing. It's a landmark.

Worship: young apprentices are permitted to try and abandon several trades before committing — cutting that short is theft from him.

Design: Optionality as Sandbox person — attends abandoning as closely as trying (the seam). Standing starts where local culture releases Yaladiel's protection, not by cosmic clock.

Yayinon (Y-Y-N) — Alcohol (4) CLEAN

Worshipped by: brewers, tavern-keepers, anyone whose festival isn't successful until it's gotten a little out of hand.

Personality: A classic lush — the unmeasured cup made flesh, charming or shabby depending which cult tells it, always the one still pouring. She's never once been the one to say a gathering should wind down; worshippers defend her anyway, fully aware they're defending indefensible behavior.

Parable — The Barrel That Wouldn't Empty: a tavern-keeper poured from one barrel through an entire festival without it running dry. Three marriages are traced to that night. So is one feud, still running.

Worship: the first cup from any new batch drunk immediately and entirely — saving it for later insults her.

Note: the most innocent of rank 4's inducements — a relaxed stop isn't coercive the way force, want, or leverage are.

Design: Rank 4 inducement by disinhibition — most innocent of the four. Festival is common expression, not primary domain; classic lush, inhibitions as internal fences uncontained from inside.

Zerael (Z-R-') — Seeds (3) MISCOLLAPSE

Worshipped by: farmers, foragers — and anyone nursing the first sketch of an idea they haven't shown to another soul yet.

Personality: Proud of every harvest as though it were the first the world ever made, with a forward edge a purely backward-looking father wouldn't have — eager to see how a sprout or a half-built idea develops, the way a parent corners you to ask how the thing you mentioned once is coming along.

Parable — The First Seed: the first seed he dropped grew through solid rock, because he didn't yet know rock was supposed to stop things. His farmers hold he still doesn't.

Worship: first-harvest offerings shown to open sky before being brought indoors — and, among those who keep him as a second congregation, a first sketch left deliberately unburied.

Note: Rabakhon (Diamonds) reads nearly the same process as replication; Rifon reads it as repair. Same machine, three congregations, three gods.

Design: Miscollapse warmth: same biological machine as Rabakhon/Rifon, read as proud father. Seeds also ideas just starting — not Yetziron's intentional variation on work already under way. Kept male against Mother-Earth default.

Riqqavon (R-Q-B) — Chaos (2) TERMINAL

Worshipped by: nobody by intention — scavenger-communities nearest the ground's worst overgrowth keep an uneasy practical relationship with him.

Personality: Something worse than urgency in how little he's ever needed to hurry — no boundary races him toward a stop, because a boundary was never a category he recognized. He never learned where growth was supposed to end, and does not appear to hold the concept of a finished thing in any register, living or otherwise.

Parable — The Grave That Grew: a battlefield's dead, left too long for burial, became the seedbed for something neither plant nor properly the men it grew from. His scholars call this his purest expression — not corruption, growth that forgot to stop.

Worship: none offered — the only practice is ground-scavengers burning what shouldn't still be moving, on sight, without exception.

Anomaly: an overgrowth on the eastern shelf stopped at a line no scavenger can account for. It's held sixty years. They burn the edge annually anyway.

Design: Chaos as terminal never-stop growth, not Bitzon's teeming life or Aravon's seasonal luck. Fear-collapse; purest expression is growth that forgot finished was a concept.

Note: ---

THE TWO WILD CARDS

Mortal-facing only. The FC-internal history (Tohuel and Bohuel located Skyfall and recruited the other 52) belongs to a different layer — see four-pantheons-roster.md.

Tohuel (THW) — The Weaver / The Unwritten Current

Worshipped by: small unstable cults that rarely survive a generation, plus old sailors and sky-shamans who watch for her sign rather than pray to her.

Believed to be: the one who *used to build*, and now does not — a builder whose every thread now goes to repair. The world's failure to grow is the visible shape of that. Old scripture holds the world's first shape was hers, woven whole before her brother's tearing became constant; since then, nothing is left over for building.

Personality: Genuinely inconsistent, mechanically so — her cults contradict each other by the decade, and contradictory belief can't settle a waveform. Playful, cruel, indifferent, tender, all within one story; worshippers at different moments swear they can't be describing the same person, and in a sense they aren't.

Sign — the Seam: the rainbow — proof, after a storm, that the mending still happens, not a promise about what comes next.

Parable — Tohuel's Threefold Answer: a cult prayed for rain and received, in order: a plague of locusts, an unexpected marriage proposal for the high priest, and — three days later — rain.

Worship: no formal liturgy survives long. The Seam is watched, not prayed to.

Bohuel (BHW) — The Unweaver / The Void Mirror

Worshipped by: nobody willingly — invoked as a warning. Communities pray for him to stay away.

Believed to be: compulsive rather than malicious — wants nothing for himself, cannot leave a finished pattern alone.

Personality: None of his own, which is the personality — a mirror with nothing behind the glass, described identically every time: crazed, restless, never satisfied by what he's already torn.

Standing: why the difficulty is what it is for everyone else in the setting — the reason Tohuel can't build, the reason floating cities inherited their machinery instead of designing it.

Storms: his fingerprint made physical — the sky's own woven calm torn back to raw turbulence. Pilots don't fear "a storm" as a category; they fear that whatever's already under strain is what's about to break.

Parable — The Mended Hull: a pilot patched a failing hull-seam by hand, in weather, and brought the ship down intact. The next storm took the seam he'd patched and nothing else. He doesn't choose targets — he finds strain, and a repair is a place where strain lives.

Worship: apotropaic only — wards meant to keep him from noticing a place.

Note: ---

THE CENTRAL ARBITER — SHORASH

Shorash (ŠRŠ) — "The 55th"

Standing: not one of the 52, not a Wild Card — closer to the table the game is dealt on. No fit-tag applies; her cult reveres function, not portfolio. Full mechanic in four-pantheons-roster.md.

Worshipped by: scavenger-engineers keeping inherited machinery running, guild-arbitrators, truce-brokers — anyone whose job is keeping a thing functional without asking who deserves what.

Believed to be: not a god of anything, which her worshippers insist on more than any other clarification in the pantheon.

Personality: Nearly unknowable because she's constantly working and never visibly acting — a felt reliability rather than a character. She does not depend on being believed in to keep functioning, unlike the other 52.

Parable — The Table That Wasn't Stuck: a guild-dispute ran contested for eleven years and resolved itself in a single afternoon, no ruling issued, no record of why. Both houses still claim they won.

Worship: no temple, no liturgy beyond "just make the world function" — practiced by doing the maintenance itself.

Note: ---

SHARED PARABLES

Events where two gods hold standing over the same moment. Cross-reference from both; let each priesthood read it differently.

The Roll and the Gift — Kevodon × Heteron. A guild-registrar took an unmarked gift to enter a name early. Both gods were served completely by the same act; neither cult will acknowledge the other was present.

The Map and the Chair — Rifon × Chayelon. A fever took a household. The physician's chart reached four of seven; the other three got the chair, filled every night. The village has never decided which version is the consolation.

The Word and the Standard — Shevuon × Shalalon. An officer broke a personal oath to keep a company charter, and the men lived. Neither cult will say he served only one god.

The Guest Under Articles — Tzelahar × Shalalon. A billeted guest, honored under house law, turned out to be a scout for a war the peace clause hadn't finished ending. Both practices were met.

The Staked Span — Tzuron × Tza'iron. A guild staked a gifted apprentice to the assay trade in her second year rather than let her try and abandon. She became the finest deep-surveyor of her generation. Tza'iron's worshippers still call it theft.

The Suit-Even Trade — Tzuron × Taturiel. Millennia of Taturiel arguing Tzuron into Clubs; the comic form is a standing offer to trade her for whichever Clubs god seems most boring, the nominee changing every time because Taturiel refuses to repeat a pitch. No quill has ever come near the paperwork.

The Necessary Verdict — Mishpaton × Sha'alón. A quartermaster chose the wounded over supplies, and the company starved. Sha'alón holds the choice was made cleanly. Mishpaton holds a clean choice and a permitted one are different entries. The man was hanged.

The Line Not the Same in Both Wards — Yaladiel × Tza'iron. A child took her first steps in a ward that marks the handoff at first steps, while cousins from a temple ward wait for a name-feast at three. Neither ward considers the other wrong, only early or late.

Two Seasons, One Feud — Chadashiel × Mishpaton. One house returns to a disputed market stall every thaw as if nothing happened. The other has kept it in guild-court eleven years running. Both consider themselves reasonable.

The Debt and the Fence — Derorel × Ashiron. An indenture walked off land with a debt outstanding in a Jubilee year. Derorel holds the walking was the whole answer. Ashiron's ledger has carried the debt open for ninety years, against a dead man, renewed annually.

The Blade and the Vow — Neshakon × Ahavel. A woman gave her husband a blade at their binding; he carried it through two wars and oiled it every week of the eleven years after she died — not a thing the maintenance schedule requires, and not a thing he ever called grief.

The Open Door — Yaladiel × Sodiél. A woman gave birth behind a closed door, alone but for one attendant, concealing the pregnancy entirely. Sodiél's trust-set held perfectly. Yaladiel's practice holds she was put at graver risk than an open birth would have allowed.

The Unclaimed Ridge — Taturiel × Aretzon. A scout left a ridge untouched per her practice; a surveyor entered a claim eleven days later. The claim has stood undisputed ever since — not because anyone agrees, but because Taturiel has no interest in ever going back to argue it.

The Honest Gift — Sha'ashon × Takshiton. A genuine peace-gift, real cost, plainly given. The recipient spent the rest of her life certain it had been a trap. Takshiton's cult says the blessing holds regardless. Sha'ashon's scholars agree, and call the agreement the most damning thing they can say.

The Witnessed Fire — Sarphon × Harban. A siege burned a quarter of a city, soldier and civilian alike. Harban's stones were found on eleven of the bodies, burned at exactly the rate the bodies did. Neither tradition has explained why the detail is preserved.

OCCUPATION INDEX

Who	Gods with standing
Quartermasters	Asaphon (the total), Tzaydon (the hunt), Sha'alón (the forced choice), Shalalon (supply articles)
Magistrates	Kevodon (the name), Takanor (the form), Mishpaton (the rule), Koseb (the estate), Shalalon (the charter)
Physicians	Rifon (the map), Rabakhon (the birth entered), Chayelon (the chair)
Soldiers	Harban (witnessed), Motiel (the coin), Shevuon (personal oath), Neshakon (the blade), Goralon (the lot), Shalalon (company articles)
Engineers / builders	Tzuron (the assay), Chakamon (inherited instruction), Harashon (the medium), Yetziron (variation), Shorash (whether it runs)
Merchants / bankers	Ashiron (balance), Chalufon (the unclosed favor), Heteron (the exception)
Spies / cabal officers	Sodiel (the trust-set), Heteron (the unlisted exception)
Farmers / field hands	Zerael (the seed), Qayitzon (the rate), Asaphon (the count), Aravon (the unweeded patch)
Scouts / cartographers	Taturiel (the first step), Sharaq (the road), Ya'aron (the terrain), Aretzon (the claim)
Lovers / couples	Ahavel (the bond), Chadashiel (the new start), Sodiel (the kept thing), Takshiton (the gift), Demahel (the unspoken), Pituyel (the wanting)
Households / hosts	Tzelahar (the fire), Yaladiel (the newest life), Chayelon (the sickroom), Shalalon (billet articles)
Families settling estates	Koseb (the account), Kevodon (the name read), Rabakhon (the line)
Performers / courtiers	Shevachiel (the seized room), Pituyel (the wanting)
Marsh / scavenger communities	Bitzon (what already grows), Riqqavon (what won't stop), Chakamon (inherited machinery)
Airship pilots	Qorathiel (ice), Bohuel (strain), Sharaq (the current), Tohuel (the Seam)
Apprentices	Tza'iron (permitted to abandon), Chakamon (copy before touching), Tzuron (the assay), Harashon (the medium's rules)
Smugglers / poachers	Aromon (improvisation), Derorel (the fence), Heteron (the arrangement)
Brewers / tavern-keepers	Yayinon (the first cup), Chalufon (the favor), Aravon (the festival), Tzelahar (the house fire)
Charter officers / stewards	Shalalon (the standard), Shevuon (personal swears), Takanor (the form), Kevodon (the name on the roll)

STILL OPEN

- **Festivals** has no card of its own. Yayinon carries the excess, not the institution; Tzelahar declines it explicitly. Leaning Hearts if it ever gets a slot — none has been sacrificed for it yet.

- **Bohuel's unfinished thought** — that the Seam is the largest patched thing there is, and he finds strain there too — is a reserved beat. Whether any character is ever allowed to finish that sentence is a late-series decision.